

The incredibly useful smartphone apps

Thought you'd seen them all? We bet you've not downloaded these, yet!

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This month on App Watch, we take a look at some of the apps that you absolutely should have on your smartphone. Some add a dollop of additional functionality, while others are fun to use as well. Since all of them can be downloaded for free, we urge you to take them for a spin.

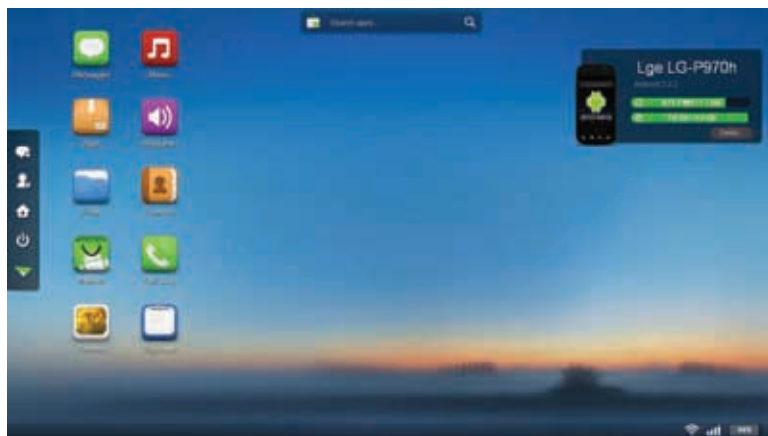
Extra assistance while driving iOnRoad Augmented Driving

Available for: Android

Price: Free

This app is possibly the perfect driving companion, apart

from a GPS navigator. Requiring the phone to be mounted on one of the universal windshield mounts, the app keeps an eye on the road in front via the camera. There will be a loud beep alert as well as a text alert on the display when the distance to the car in front becomes uncomfortably less. There are two settings for the distance which you can preset. The camera needs to be in a clear line of sight for this to work. However, it detects vehicles and objects in a V angle only, beyond which everything is a blind spot. While you should be attentive at all times while driving, we think this app can be very useful in case you just take your eyes off the road for a second, and something pops up in your path.



The one size fits all desktop access for Android phones

Not only that, iOnRoad can also be set for speed alerts that notify you the moment you go above the limit. It's more of an annoyance usually, and is better turned off. The SMS Reader feature is immensely useful though. You can set iOnRoad to route all calls to the speaker while driving. The auto driving detection feature automatically starts up the app when you start driving, if the phone is in the mount on the dash. You'll need to buy a universal mount to put this phone in, for your car. There are a lot of them available in retail stores and online shops.

Can't find that data cable

AirDroid

Available for:

Android

Price: Free

Accessing the data on Android phones

can be a very painful experience, particularly if you're using Mac OS, or if you don't have a data cable readily available. AirDroid is a must-have app in such a situation. Open AirDroid on your Android phone, then enter the given web address in a browser on any PC connected on the same Wi-Fi network and enter coordinates the app throws up. Enter the auto-generated password and voila! All phone data is right there – contacts, messages, media, apps, capability to send a message, copy data to and from the device and even browse and downloads apps from Android Market.

Free calls and messages

Viber

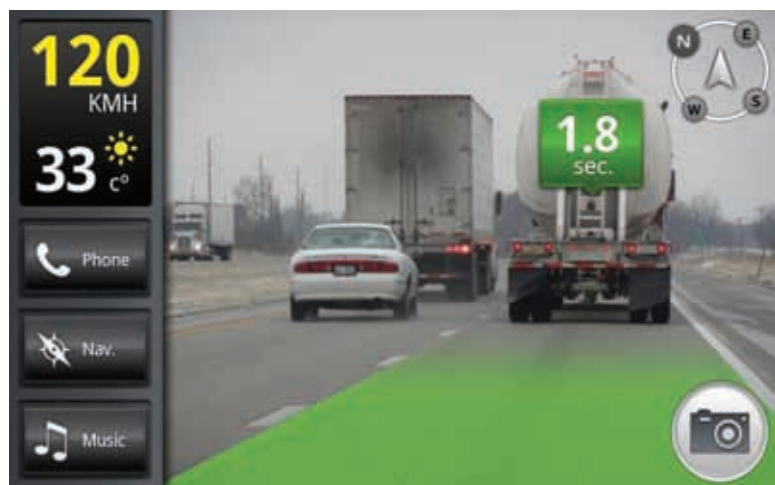
Available for: iOS

and Android; Coming

soon on BlackBerry

Price: Free

This is something of a mix of two apps that you may already



Another eye on the road, for your safety